

Our Day, As Lived

A map of one homeschooling family's real weekday, before deciding what to change

Prepared October 10, 2026 · From a one-question-at-a-time interview, the kids' printed schedules, the morning checklist, and both Google Calendars (Sept 28 – Oct 16)

What this is: a picture of the day you are actually living. Nothing here is a recommendation. Pressure points are named so you can look at them, not so they can be fixed yet.

YOU SAID

 your own words or facts you gave

DOCUMENT

 from schedules, checklist, or calendar

MY INFERENCE

 a pattern I'm drawing; please test it

MISSING

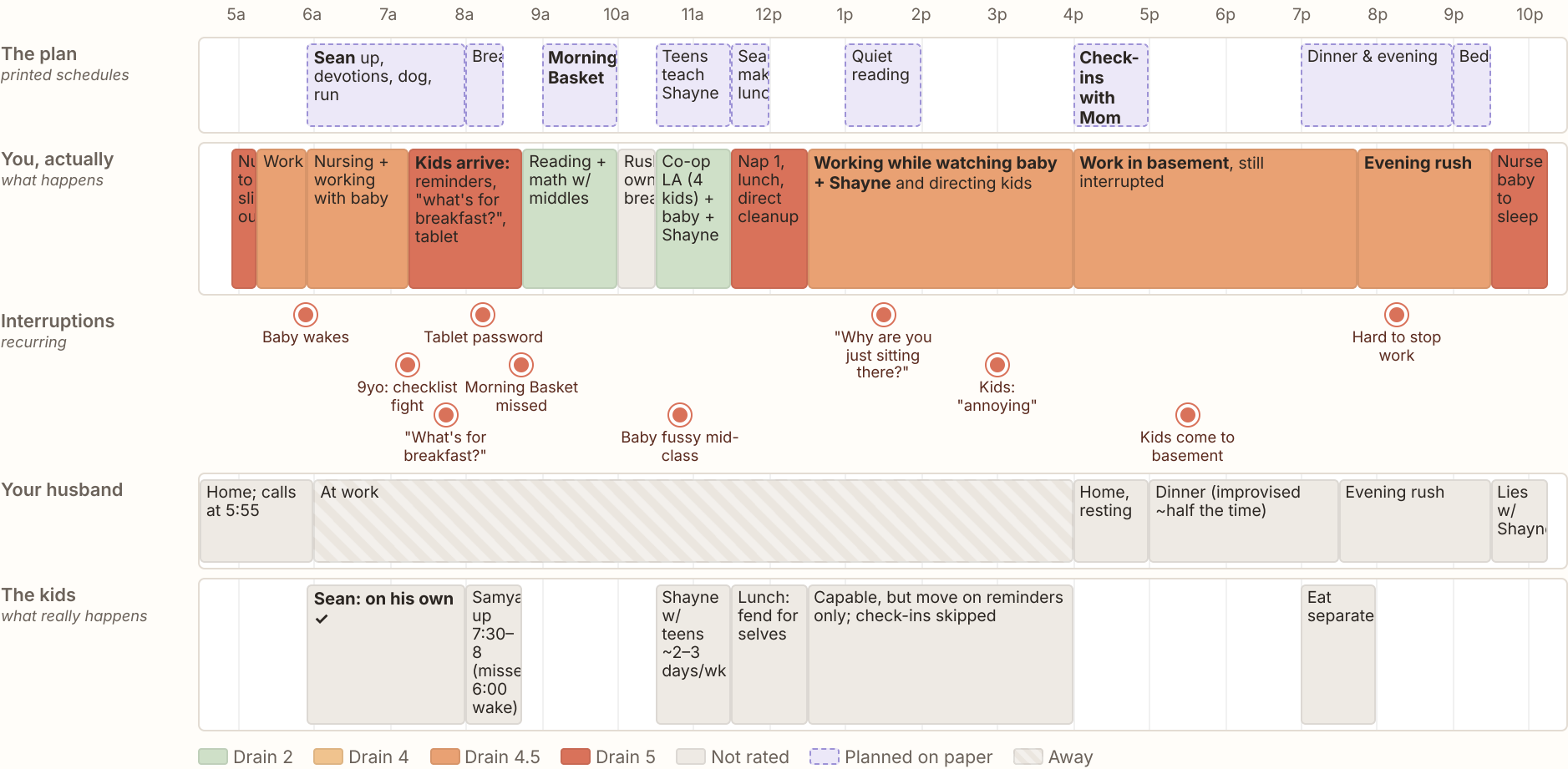
 not covered or unclear; not guessed

Who's in the home

PERSON	WHAT WE KNOW
You	YOU SAID Homeschooling mom, runs a business (Reels, carousels, meetings), nursing the baby day and night.
Your husband	YOU SAID Gone by 6 a.m., home around 4 p.m., "exhausted from these days."
Sean, 15	YOU SAID age 15 · DOCUMENT name and weekly schedule
Samyah, 12	YOU SAID age 12 and spelling · DOCUMENT weekly schedule (printed as "Samaya")
9-year-old son	MY INFERENCE possibly Shai (calendar: "MyTek Shai & Selah," "Shai soccer," "Shai's birthday" Oct 11) CONFIRM
7-year-old daughter	MY INFERENCE possibly Selah CONFIRM
Shayne, 3	YOU SAID age 3 · DOCUMENT "Teach Shayne, Purely Preschool" on the teens' schedules
The baby, 1	YOU SAID age 1 · MY INFERENCE possibly Sophia (calendar: "Sophia's 12 m MMR") CONFIRM
The dog	DOCUMENT Sean's 6:00 block includes "dog" · YOU SAID Sean does his early block on his own

The Day Map: a typical home weekday (Tue–Thu)

Colored blocks show how draining *you* rated each part of the day. Purple dashed blocks are what the printed schedules say should happen. Red pins are recurring interruptions you described.



Overnight (~10:15 p.m. – 4:55 a.m.) · drain 4.5–5 · baby co-sleeps and nurses **3×** (good night), **4–5×** (average), **6–7×** (rough). Actual sleep total: unknown.

Your work, as you describe it: 5:15–9:00 interrupted ≈ "one hour of uninterrupted work." Then 12:30–4:00 and 4:00–7:30/8:00, also interrupted.

1 · The day, hour by hour

A typical home weekday, Tuesday through Thursday (the days the co-op kids come, per the calendar).

TIME	WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENS	WHAT YOU'RE CARRYING IN YOUR HEAD	PLAN SAYS
4:55	YOU SAID Alarm. Baby stirs when you move, so you nurse her and slip in the pacifier to get out of bed.	How to leave without waking her	
5:15–5:55	YOU SAID Downstairs working: Reel scripts, organizing.	Your business	
~5:55	YOU SAID Husband calls: baby's awake. You go up, nurse, and when she won't settle, carry her down and work while nursing or with her on the carpet.	Work + baby at once	DOC Sean up 5:55; Samyah up 6:00
6:00	YOU SAID You're supposed to wake Samyah (no alarm, because her sister shares the room) but you're working or nursing, so it's missed. She's up around 7:30–8:00. Husband gone by 6.	Samyah's wake-up is yours	DOC Samyah: devotions, laundry, dressed, makes breakfast by 7:00
6:00–8:00	YOU SAID Sean does his whole early block on his own.	-	DOC Dressed, devotions, dog, run
~7:15–7:20	YOU SAID 9-year-old comes to lie with or on you. You remind him about his checklist; he whines, complains, and yells, then does it. Then the 7-year-old: same reminder. Then Shayne. Everyone asks "what's for breakfast?"	Checklist status for each child; breakfast decided on the spot	DOC 3-part checklist: Bedroom → Bathroom → Kitchen
~8:15	YOU SAID Sean brings the tablet for the math password. The same daily back-and-forth: did you finish breakfast and your checklist first?	Judging whether he's done or "improvising"	DOC Breakfast 8:00, math 8:30
8:30–9:00	YOU SAID Still trying to work. Realize it's too late for Morning Basket.	Whether to stop working	DOC Morning Basket 9:00 (Samyah) / 9:30 (Sean)
~9:00–10:00	YOU SAID All About Reading and math with the 9- and 7-year-old.	Teaching (drain 2)	
~10:00–10:30	YOU SAID Kids play outside or have free play while you rush to make your own breakfast. Friend's two kids arrive.	Your first meal	DOC Outside 10:00
10:30–11:30	YOU SAID Christian Light Education language arts for four kids (your 9- and 7-year-old plus your friend's two). Baby gets fussy and is often nursed down for nap 1 <i>during</i> class. Shayne is either with the teens or in your class "just getting in the way."	Teaching + baby + Shayne at once	DOC Teens teach Shayne 10:30 / 11:00 · CAL "LA and Spelling" Tue–Thu

11:30–12:30	YOU SAID Baby nursed down if not already. Lunch: everyone fend for themselves; you direct cleanup.	"I don't want to think about it"	DOC Sean makes lunch 11:30
12:30–4:00	YOU SAID Working the whole time while watching the baby and Shayne and directing everyone else ("go outside," "clean something," "quiet time," "tidy your zone"). Baby's nap 2 falls somewhere 3:30–4:30.	Everyone's whereabouts and progress	DOC Lunch, history, quiet reading, independent work
~4:00	YOU SAID Husband home. You hand everything to him; he takes off his shoes and rests on the couch, sometimes scrolling. The 4:00/4:30 check-ins don't happen ; you've been checking in all day instead.	Handoff	DOC "Check your work with Mom" 4:00 · "Check in with Mom" 4:30
4:00–7:30/8:00	YOU SAID Working in the basement where kids play and the TV is on; they still come to you. For real focus you sometimes work in the car. Husband handles dinner: about half the time it's improvised (pizza loaf, fish sticks, "fend for yourselves"). You eat separately.	Your work; when to stop	DOC Dinner 7:00
7:30–9:30	YOU SAID Either too tired and scrolling, or you're still working ("a really hard time stopping"), or no one's watching the clock. Then a rush: zones, showers, bed. "Very hectic, not peaceful, not calm."	Getting everyone down	DOC Bedtime 9:00
9:30–10:30	YOU SAID Husband lies down with Shayne; you nurse the baby to sleep in your bed and fall asleep around 10:00–10:30. He comes to bed later.	-	

2 · Recurring decisions you make every day

DECISION	WHEN	SOURCE
What's for breakfast	~7:15–8:00, asked on the spot	YOU SAID drain 5 on the spot vs. ~2–2.5 if decided ahead
Has each child done their checklist?	Each child's arrival downstairs	YOU SAID
Did Sean finish before math? (the tablet password)	~8:15	YOU SAID
Do we still do Morning Basket?	8:30–9:00	YOU SAID usually "too late"
Who's teaching Shayne today, and are the teens on track?	All morning	YOU SAID happens ~2–3 days/week
Where is each child and are they working? ("Why are you just sitting there?")	All day	YOU SAID drain 5

What to send a restless child to do (outside, clean, quiet time, zones)	Afternoons	YOU SAID
Lunch	11:30–12:30	YOU SAID left to the kids, but you supervise cleanup
When to stop working	Morning and evening	YOU SAID "a really hard time stopping"
What to prepare before an outing (food, documents, books)	Appointment days	YOU SAID (Friday) · MY INFERENCE this happens in the moment, not the night before

3 · Who owns what today

PERSON	OWNS OR DOES ON THEIR OWN	SUPPOSED TO, BUT IT LANDS ON YOU
You	YOU SAID Night and day nursing · Samyah's wake-up · all reminders and check-ins · breakfast decisions · teaching the middles and the co-op · supervising the baby and Shayne while working · tablet access · bedtime nursing · appointments and errands · your business	
Your husband	YOU SAID Calls when the baby wakes (~5:55) · takes the kids at ~4:00 · dinner (improvised about half the time) · lies down with Shayne at bedtime	MISSING What he does with the kids between 4:00 and dinner; the other half of dinners; kitchen cleanup
Sean, 15	YOU SAID His whole 5:55–8:00 block, including the dog	YOU SAID Making lunch ("rarely, if ever") · teaching Shayne (about half the time) · 4:30 check-in
Samyah, 12	MISSING what she reliably does on her own	YOU SAID 6:00 wake-up (needs you) · making breakfast · teaching Shayne · 4:00 check-in
9- and 7-year-old	YOU SAID Capable of checklists, independent work (Teaching Textbooks, Explode the Code, worksheets, MyTek), chores, helping with Shayne and the baby	YOU SAID "They don't do anything without the constant reminders." They need you for reading, language arts, and math.
Shayne, 3	YOU SAID Watched by you most of the day unless the teens are teaching him · needs a parent to lie down with him at bedtime	
The baby	YOU SAID Nurses throughout the day and night · naps ~10:30–11:30 and ~3:30–4:30 · co-sleeps with you	

4 · Energy and time

Your ratings, 1 = barely notice, 5 = drains me.

RESPONSIBILITY	DRAIN	YOUR NOTES
Night nursing / broken sleep	4.5–5	YOU SAID "Incredibly draining." 4.5–5
Reminding and checking on the kids all day	5	YOU SAID "Mentally draining"
Deciding meals on the spot	5	YOU SAID Ahead of time it would be ~2–2.5
Early-morning work, 5:15–9:00 (interrupted)	4.5	YOU SAID Nearly 4 hours ≈ 1 hour of focused work

Watching the baby and Shayne while working	4.5	YOU SAID
Afternoon and evening work (interrupted)	4.5	YOU SAID
Evening and bedtime rush	4.5	YOU SAID
Business work itself	4	YOU SAID "But I enjoy my work"
Teaching (middles + co-op)	2	YOU SAID
Driving and appointments	2	YOU SAID "Not really draining to drive"

5 · Where the day gets heavy

These are the places your answers kept circling back to. Each one keeps **what you said** separate from **what I'm inferring**.

A. The nights feed the days

YOU SAID 3 to 7 wake-ups a night; rated 4.5–5. Moving her to her own bed hasn't happened because "we're just too tired to even deal with nighttime battles on top of daytime battles."

MY INFERENCE Every other part of the day starts from this level of tiredness.

B. 7:15–9:00: everything arrives at once

YOU SAID Work you can't easily leave, the baby, four kids arriving one at a time, checklist reminders, the breakfast question, and the tablet negotiation. Morning Basket gets lost.

MY INFERENCE Samyah's missed 6:00 wake-up removes breakfast from the morning, so the breakfast decision moves onto you at your busiest moment.

C. You are the household's clock

YOU SAID "It all depends on me reminding them." You are Samyah's alarm, the reminder for every task the middles do, and the reason the teens stay on schedule. The written check-ins don't happen.

MY INFERENCE The schedules and checklists exist and the kids are capable, so what seems to be missing is something besides you that starts each next step.

D. Working while supervising, all day

YOU SAID Nearly four early-morning hours $\approx$ one hour of focused work. The afternoon and evening are interrupted too (4.5), with work happening in the basement among the kids and the TV.

MY INFERENCE Your work and your parenting are almost never separated in time or space, so both feel unfinished.

E. Meals decided in the moment

YOU SAID Breakfast on the spot = 5; decided ahead = $\sim$ 2–2.5. Lunch is fend-for-yourself; dinner is improvised about half the time; meals are eaten separately.

F. The 4:00 handoff and the evening

YOU SAID Your husband arrives exhausted. You hand off and go back to work until 7:30–8:00. Bedtime is "very hectic, not peaceful."

MY INFERENCE The handoff is between two depleted adults, and there's no shared stopping point that marks the end of the workday for either of you.

G. Unwritten logistics (what happened Friday)

YOU SAID Kids woken late, nothing prepared the night before, breakfast was yogurt, 3 hours of therapy with hungry kids, a DMV trip that failed because your license was at home, rushing to post a carousel, then late again for Samyah's 4:00 PT, where you had a panic attack. School was the first thing to go.

CALENDAR Only the three therapy sessions and a 6:30–8:30 work meeting are on the calendar. **The DMV and Samyah's PT aren't on either calendar.**

MY INFERENCE Twice that day, time slipped away while you were working (7:00 and 3:00). Everything that went wrong depended on preparation that existed only in your head.

6 · What you wish could happen (and rarely does)

- **YOU SAID** Sitting down to Morning Basket
- **YOU SAID** Knowing what's for dinner at the start of the day
- **YOU SAID** The kids know what's expected and move through it on their own
- **YOU SAID** Stopping work at a set point
- **YOU SAID** Your husband gets a chance to recharge after work so he can rejoin the family
- **YOU SAID** Family worship together: Bible reading, talking, connecting
- **YOU SAID** Eating dinner together
- **YOU SAID** The baby sleeping in her own bed

7 · Missing or unclear (not guessed)

- **CONFIRM** Names of the 9- and 7-year-old (Shai and Selah?) and the baby (Sophia?).
- **CONFIRM** "Apology of math" may be voice typing. What math curriculum do the middles use?
- **MISSING** **Monday and Friday mornings.** The calendar shows the co-op kids only Tue–Thu. What do Mon and Fri look like?
- **MISSING** **Evening activity nights** (e.g., soccer). How do they change 4:00–9:30?
- **MISSING** **Housework:** laundry, kitchen cleanup, groceries, cleaning. Not covered in the interview.
- **MISSING** **Weekends,** and your own rest, devotions, and meals.
- **MISSING** Who drives the co-op kids to and from your house.
- **MISSING** Whether the 9- and 7-year-old have their own written schedules.
- **UNCLEAR** Friday's 6:30–8:30 M2H Lead Team meeting: were you on it while waking the kids?
- **UNCLEAR** The weekly Friday therapy sessions: who are they for and who goes?
- **UNCLEAR** MyTek: schedules say "live Mondays," the calendar shows Tuesdays 3:00–4:00.
- **UNCLEAR** Morning Basket time: 9:00 on Samyah's schedule, 9:30 on Sean's.
- **UNCLEAR** "The night is perfect, but..." trailed off. Was there more?

- **UNCLEAR** Your actual hours of sleep.

8 · Questions to sit with (not solutions)

- Looking at the map, which pressure point, if it eased, would make the others lighter?
- Which of the things you carry in your head could be carried by something or someone else, and which do you want to keep?
- What does your husband see when he looks at this map?

"Come to me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest." (Matthew 11:28)